

Retail Sector Performance Across Australian States: Identifying Growth Industries in the Post-Pandemic Era (2020–2025)

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Table of contents

1 Executive Summary	1
2 Introduction	1
3 Methodology	2
4 Results	2
5 Discussion and Conclusion	2
6 References	2
Bibliography	2

1 Executive Summary

2 Introduction

The Australian retail industry plays an important role in the national economy through its contribution to employment, household consumption, and overall economic activity. Retail performance is also closely linked to changes in consumer confidence and broader economic conditions across Australian states and industries.

The COVID-19 pandemic caused substantial disruption to the Australian retail sector due to lockdowns, mobility restrictions, and changing consumer behaviour. While some retail industries experienced significant declines during the pandemic, others benefited from increased household spending and shifts toward home-based consumption.

Understanding post-pandemic retail recovery is important because recovery patterns were uneven across both states and retail industries. Differences in reopening policies, labour market conditions, inflation, and consumer preferences contributed to varying levels of retail growth between 2020 and 2025.

This report investigates which Australian states and retail industries contributed most strongly to post-pandemic retail recovery between 2020 and 2025. Using seasonally adjusted retail turnover data published by the Australian Bureau of Statistics, the report examines variation in retail performance across regions and industries during the recovery period.

The remainder of this report is structured as follows. The methodology section describes the data preparation and analytical approach, followed by the results section presenting key findings and visualisations. The final section discusses the implications of the results and provides concluding remarks and recommendations.

3 Methodology

4 Results

5 Discussion and Conclusion

6 References

Bibliography